

Astrans Books

How Bigcapital Handles Accounting

Practical guide for Astrans Global (Pvt) Ltd - based on project docs (CHART_OF_ACCOUNTS, EVENT_POSTING_MATRIX, VAT_SL_1B). Currency: LKR.

Books URL: <https://books.astransdms.xyz>

1. Big picture

Astrans uses two systems on purpose:

- Astrans Books (Bigcapital) = accounting core: GL, AR/AP, inventory valuation, VAT postings, reports.
- Astrans DMS = distribution ops: routes, vans, collections UX - not a second Trial Balance.

When stock or money moves in the field, DMS should create an event that posts into Bigcapital as a real document (invoice, bill, payment, transfer), not a silent spreadsheet.

What Bigcapital is good at

- Double-entry ledger that stays balanced
- Sales invoices, purchase bills, customer/vendor payments
- Inventory quantity + value (COGS when you sell stock items)
- Tax lines on documents (VAT rate -> VAT accounts)
- Financial statements: Trial Balance, P&L, Balance Sheet

What belongs in DMS (not rebuilt in Bigcapital screens)

- Route planning / salesman beats
- Van load sheets and delivery UX
- Field credit-limit enforcement UI
- Territory hierarchy screens

Those ops flows still must produce events that hit the posting matrix when stock or money moves.

2. Chart of Accounts (COA) - the filing system

Every posting hits named accounts. Astrans starter COA (from project docs) groups like:

Group	Examples	Role
Assets	Inventory, AR, Banks, VAT Paid	What we own / are owed
Liabilities	AP, VAT Control, Director CA	What we owe
Equity	Share capital, Retained earnings	Owners residual
Income	Sales, commission, interest	Revenue
COGS / Expense	COGS, fuel, rent, salary	Costs

Rule of thumb: pick the account that matches the economic reality. Do not invent SL tax accounts casually - keep VAT Control / VAT Paid names familiar to the accountant.

3. Double-entry in one sentence

Every transaction has at least two sides. Debits must equal credits. Bigcapital documents build those sides for you when you fill the form correctly.

4. Day-to-day tasks with examples

A) Sell goods on credit (Sales Invoice)

Customer takes stock today; pays later. Bigcapital Sales Invoice decreases inventory (if stock item), raises AR, records sales + output VAT, and posts COGS.

Example - invoice LKR 100,000 + 18% VAT (illustrative rate)

Dr Accounts Receivable	118,000
Cr Sales	100,000
Cr VAT Control (output)	18,000
Dr COGS	(cost of items)
Cr Inventory	(same cost)

DMS event: Sale confirmed -> Bigcapital Sales Invoice

B) Collect cash / bank from customer (Receive payment)

No stock movement. Clears AR into Bank/Cash.

Example - customer pays LKR 50,000 to HNB

Dr Hatton National Bank	50,000
Cr Accounts Receivable	50,000

DMS event: Customer collection received -> Payment Received

C) Buy stock from supplier (Bill / GRN)

Inventory goes up; we owe the supplier; recoverable input VAT may apply.

Example - purchase LKR 40,000 + VAT 7,200

Dr Inventory	40,000
Dr VAT Paid (input)	7,200
Cr Accounts Payable	47,200

DMS event: Purchase / GRN + supplier bill -> Bill + inventory

D) Pay supplier

Example - pay LKR 47,200 from bank

Dr Accounts Payable	47,200
Cr Bank	47,200

DMS event: Supplier payment made -> Vendor payment

E) Move stock to a van / branch (Inventory transfer)

Usually no P&L hit if it is only a location change. Inventory leaves Warehouse A and arrives Warehouse B.

Example - 20 cases to Van 03

Stock: Warehouse Main -20 cases

Stock: Van 03 +20 cases

Value: same inventory value (transfer, not sale)

DMS event: Stock issued to van/route -> Inventory transfer

F) Customer / van return (Credit note)

If goods come back restockable, reverse the sales economics with a credit note (and inventory increase). Exact VAT/COGS reverse depends on return type.

G) Write-off / damage

Example - damaged stock cost LKR 5,000

Dr Expense / COGS (write-off) 5,000

Cr Inventory 5,000

DMS event: Stock write-off -> Inventory adjustment (+ journal if needed)

H) Operating expense (fuel, rent)

Example - fuel LKR 12,000 paid from petty cash

Dr Fuel expense 12,000

Cr Petty cash 12,000

DMS event: Expense recorded -> Expense / bill

I) Manual journal (exceptions only)

Use for opening balances, rare corrections, or items with no native document. Still must balance. Prefer invoices/bills/payments whenever possible.

5. DMS event -> Bigcapital posting matrix

Contract between ops and books (from EVENT_POSTING_MATRIX.md):

#	DMS event	Bigcapital document
1	Sale confirmed	Sales Invoice (+ COGS)
2	Customer collection	Payment received
3	Purchase / GRN + bill	Bill + inventory
4	Supplier payment	Vendor payment
5	Stock to van/branch	Inventory transfer
6	Stock return	Credit note + inventory
7	Write-off / damage	Inventory adjustment
8	Expense	Expense / bill
9	Bank/cash transfer	Transfer / journal
10	Manual adjustment	Manual journal
11	Opening balances	Opening journal / OB

Posting rules (v1)

- DMS never posts silently to GL without a mapped event.
- Prefer Bigcapital native documents over raw journals.
- Journals are for exceptions only.
- Taxable sales/purchases must carry VAT rate and hit VAT accounts.
- Each DMS event ID posts at most once (store Bigcapital document id).

6. VAT - decision 1B (project rule)

Phase A (go-live books): configure VAT rates on sales/purchases; post to VAT Control / VAT Paid; give the accountant tax liability style summaries. Do not block deploy on a full RAMIS UI.

Phase B (later): Sri Lanka VAT output/input schedules, net VAT payable/refundable, Excel export matching accountant columns. Optional later: SSCL, WHT certificates.

Keep familiar account names: VAT Control Account, VAT Paid, WHT Receivable.

Numbers in earlier examples used an illustrative 18% only to show the shape of entries. Always use the VAT rates configured in Astrans Books for live postings.

7. Reports you use in Bigcapital

Report	Question it answers
Trial Balance	Do all accounts balance this period?
Profit & Loss	Did we make profit? Which income/expense?
Balance Sheet	What do we own/owe on a date?
AR / AP aging	Who owes us / whom we owe, by age
Inventory valuation	Stock qty and value on hand
Tax / VAT summaries	Output vs input for the period (Phase A)

8. Click-path cheat sheet (Astrans Books)

Sell

- Sales -> Invoices -> New invoice -> add customer & lines -> publish/deliver as required

Collect

- Sales / Payments received -> apply against invoice(s) -> choose bank/cash account

Buy

- Purchases -> Bills -> New bill -> supplier, items, tax -> receive inventory if needed

Pay supplier

- Purchases / Payments made -> apply to bill(s)

Move stock

- Inventory / Warehouses -> Transfer between warehouses (Main <-> Van)

Expense

- Expenses -> New expense -> category, payment account, tax if any

Check books

- Accounting / Reports -> Trial Balance, P&L, Balance Sheet

9. Users, login, and passwords (ops note)

Invite staff from Preferences -> Users (do not use public Sign up - it is disabled). Forgot password emails go out via configured Gmail SMTP (MAIL_* on the VM). Invited users do not need Google App Passwords; only the server mail account does.

10. Where this comes from

- docs/bigcapital/README.md
- docs/bigcapital/CHART_OF_ACCOUNTS.md
- docs/bigcapital/EVENT_POSTING_MATRIX.md
- docs/bigcapital/VAT_SL_1B.md
- docs/bigcapital/DMS_SCOPE.md
- docs/bigcapital/CONFIGURE_COA_RUNBOOK.md

This guide explains the economic model Bigcapital uses for Astrans. It is not a substitute for your chartered accountant on Sri Lanka tax filing.